

STORAGE

Storage drives haven't been left lagging behind as technology moves on. Drives have been getting faster, more compact and cheaper than ever before. Storage devices come in all kinds of shapes and sizes depending on the needs of the user. We've tested all kinds of drives over the past year — internal hard drives, external hard drives of all sizes, portable external laptop drives and even Flash drives. We've had a few new drives come in for testing and we've had new winners as some of the comparison tests were held early in the year.

Internal Drives



REIGNING CHAMPION

Seagate 7200.11 ST3500320AS

The fastest internal hard drive we tested last year was the Seagate ST3500320AS, a 500 GB drive. Although not the fastest of all the drives of its time, it still impressed us by its performance. The 7200.11 came with 32 MB cache which one of the few drives of its time to do so. With the cache, it was able to bypass drives of much larger capacities that would be expected to be faster.

CHALLENGER

Western Digital Velociraptor 300 GB

The all new WD Velociraptor is one of the newest drives to strike back at a time when SSD's (solid state drives) threaten to nibble away at the market with claims of extremely high speeds. The WD Velociraptor with its unusual design with a tiny drive in a large cooling casing breaks all barriers. Speeds once thought unachievable were reached



BEST PERFORMER

Intel 80 GB Solid State Drive

Intel intrusion into the solid state market has taken everyone by surprise. The drive was expected to be really fast but no-one really expected it to be this fast. In write speeds, it wasn't as fast as the Western Digital Velociraptor 300 GB, and was actually about 20 MBps slower. The read speeds, on the other hand, were much more impressive. With the drives put into RAID, unbelievable speeds were reached. The random access speed was also impressive. Even though, writing data isn't its strongest point, it makes up for it in read speeds. Let's not forget that the Intel SSD is low on power and runs cool as well.

when we pitted it against the Intel SSD earlier this month. The WD Velociraptor doesn't come cheap though. This 300 GB drive is available for you at a high price tag of Rs 16,500.

AND THE WINNER IS

Seagate 7200.11 ST3500320AS

The Best Buy awards are given not only for performance but also for what makes the best sense to buy and has the best bang for the buck. The Seagate 7200.11 ST3500320AS is